

SUBJECT

1. Passage anchor

> “I still remember walking into the classroom feeling slightly lost, because science had never been my strongest **subject**.”

Passage meaning

subject = a particular area of knowledge studied at school, college, or university

科目；**學科**

Here:

> **science was not my strongest subject**

= **科學 / 理科不是我最擅長的科目**

Practice

1. Physics became one of my favourite **subjects**.

物理後來成了我最喜歡的**科目**之一。

2. Mathematics was always my strongest **subject** at school.

數學一直都是我在學校最擅長的**科目**。

Core meanings of SUBJECT

2. subject — school or academic subject

= a particular area of knowledge that is studied or taught

科目；**學科**

Examples

1. English is my favourite **subject**.

英文是最喜歡的**科目**。

2. Which **subjects** are you taking this year?

你今年修讀哪些**科目**？

This is the exact passage sense.

3. school subject

= one particular area taught in school

****學校科目；學科****

Examples

1. History is a compulsory ****school subject****.
歷史是一門必修****學科****。
2. Science was never my strongest ****school subject****.
科學從來都不是我最擅長的****學校科目****。

4. academic subject

= a field studied formally in education

****學術科目；學科****

Examples

1. Physics is a demanding ****academic subject****.
物理是一門要求很高的****學科****。
2. She has strong knowledge across several ****academic subjects****.
她對幾個****學術科目****都有很深的了解。

Topic being discussed

5. subject — topic

= the thing that people are talking, writing, thinking, or learning about

****主題；話題；題目****

Examples

1. We changed the ****subject****.
我們換了****話題****。
2. Money can be a difficult ****subject**** to discuss.
金錢可能是一個很難討論的****話題****。

This is one of the most important non-school meanings.

6. subject of discussion

= topic being discussed

****討論主題****

Examples

1. Climate change was the main ****subject of discussion****.
氣候變化是主要的****討論主題****。
2. The conversation moved to a different ****subject****.
對話轉到了另一個****話題****。

7. subject of a book / article / speech

= what a book, article, speech, etc. is about

****主題；題材****

Examples

1. The ****subject of the book**** is human memory.
這本書的****主題****是人類記憶。
2. Her speech dealt with the ****subject of education****.
她的演講談的是教育這個****主題****。

Person or thing being studied

8. subject — person taking part in research

= a person who is observed, tested, or studied in an experiment or research project

****研究對象；受試者****

Examples

1. The study involved fifty ****subjects****.
這項研究有五十名****受試者****。

2. Each **subject** completed the same task.

每位**研究對象**都完成了相同任務。

Important research sense.

9. experimental subject

= person or animal used in an experiment

實驗對象；**受試者**

Examples

1. The **experimental subjects** were divided into two groups.

實驗對象被分成兩組。

2. Researchers monitored each **subject** carefully.

研究人員仔細監測每名**受試者**。

In modern human research, **participant** is often preferred because it sounds less objectifying.

Person / object represented in art

10. subject — person or thing shown in a photograph, painting, etc.

= the main person, object, or scene represented in a work of art or image

主體；**題材**；**拍攝 / 描繪對象**

Examples

1. The **subject** of the photograph is an elderly woman.

這張照片的**主體**是一位老婦人。

2. Flowers were a common **subject** in his paintings.

花卉是他畫作中常見的**題材**。

Person under authority

11. subject — person ruled by a monarch

= a person who owes allegiance to a king, queen, or other sovereign

****臣民；國民****

Examples

1. The king's ****subjects**** were required to pay taxes.
國王的****臣民****必須繳稅。
2. Medieval rulers expected loyalty from their ****subjects****.
中世紀統治者要求****臣民****保持忠誠。

This is a distinct historical/political sense.

Grammar

12. subject — grammatical subject

= the noun, pronoun, or phrase that typically identifies who or what performs an action or is described by the verb

****主語；主詞****

Examples

1. In “She teaches physics,” ****she**** is the ****subject****.
在 “She teaches physics” 中，****she**** 是****主語****。
2. Every complete clause normally has a ****subject****.
每個完整子句通常都有一個****主語****。

Very important language-learning sense.

13. subject and object

= grammatical contrast between the element acting/being described and the element affected
****主語與賓語 / 主詞與受詞****

Examples

1. In “The teacher helped the student,” “the teacher” is the ****subject****.
在這個句子中，“the teacher” 是****主語****。
2. Students often confuse the ****subject**** with the object.
學生常把****主語****和賓語混淆。

Verb: make someone experience something

14. subject someone to something

= cause someone to experience something, often something unpleasant

使某人遭受；使某人受到

Examples

1. The workers were **subjected to harsh conditions**.

工人被迫**遭受惡劣環境**。

2. Students should not be **subjected to unnecessary pressure**.

學生不應被迫**承受不必要的壓力**。

This is a major distinct verb use.

15. subject something to testing / analysis

= cause something to undergo examination, testing, pressure, etc.

使.....接受；把.....交付檢驗

Examples

1. The material was **subjected to extreme heat**.

這種材料被**置於極端高溫下測試**。

2. The results were **subjected to further analysis**.

這些結果被**進一步分析**。

Adjective: dependent on / conditional on

16. subject to

= dependent on a particular condition or possibility

受.....限制；取決於.....；須視.....而定

Examples

1. The schedule is ****subject to change****.

時間表****可能有所變動****。

2. The offer is ****subject to approval****.

這項提議****須經批准****。

Very high-value fixed construction.

17. subject to change

= able or likely to be changed

****可能變更；如有更改****

Examples

1. Prices are ****subject to change**** without notice.

價格****可能隨時更改****，恕不另行通知。

2. The programme is ****subject to change****.

節目內容****可能調整****。

18. subject to approval

= requiring approval before becoming final

****須經批准；以批准為條件****

Examples

1. The plan is ****subject to approval**** by the board.

這項計畫****須經董事會批准****。

2. Funding is ****subject to final approval****.

資金撥款****須經最終批准****。

Adjective: likely to experience

19. subject to something

= likely or liable to experience a particular condition

****容易受到.....；易受.....影響****

Examples

1. The area is ****subject to flooding****.
這個地區****容易發生水災****。
2. Older equipment is more ****subject to failure****.
較舊的設備更****容易故障****。

This differs slightly from the “conditional on” branch.

20. subject to pressure / criticism / attack

= exposed or vulnerable to something

****受到；遭受****

Examples

1. The plan was ****subject to heavy criticism****.
這項計畫****受到強烈批評****。
2. The system is ****subject to external pressure****.
這個系統****受到外部壓力影響****。

Formal authority / rules

21. subject to a law / rule / regulation

= governed or controlled by a law or rule

****受……規範；受……約束****

Examples

1. All employees are ****subject to company rules****.
所有員工都****受公司規定約束****。
2. The transaction is ****subject to local law****.
這項交易****受當地法律規範****。

Word family

22. subjective

= based on personal feelings, opinions, or perspectives rather than purely objective facts

****主觀的****

Examples

1. Beauty is partly ****subjective****.

美感某程度上是****主觀的****。

2. Her judgment was too ****subjective****.

她的判斷太****主觀****。

This is an important family member, but its modern meaning has developed significantly.

23. subjectively

= according to personal feelings or judgment

****主觀地****

Examples

1. The experience may be perceived ****subjectively****.

這段經歷可能會被****主觀地****理解。

2. People assess risk ****subjectively****.

人們往往會****主觀地****評估風險。

24. subjectivity

= quality of being influenced by personal feelings or perspective

****主觀性****

Examples

1. Complete objectivity is difficult because of human ****subjectivity****.

因為人的****主觀性****，完全客觀並不容易。

2. The essay discusses ****subjectivity**** in interpretation.

這篇文章討論解讀中的****主觀性****。

Useful expressions

25. change the subject

= start talking about something else

****轉換話題****

Examples

1. He looked uncomfortable and quickly ****changed the subject****.

他看起來不太自在，很快就****轉換了話題****。

2. Let's ****change the subject****.

我們****換個話題****吧。

26. get onto the subject of something

= begin discussing something

****談到.....；轉到.....這個話題****

Examples

1. We somehow ****got onto the subject of school memories****.

我們不知怎地****談到了學生時代的回憶****。

2. Once they ****got onto the subject of travel****, they talked for hours.

他們一****談到旅行這個話題****，就聊了好幾個小時。

27. on the subject of...

= regarding a particular topic

****關於.....；說到.....****

Examples

1. ****On the subject of education****, she had strong opinions.

****說到教育****，她有很多鮮明的看法。

2. While we're ****on the subject of exams****, when is the next one?

既然我們正****談到考試****，下一次是甚麼時候？

28. subject matter

= the main content or topic of a book, course, discussion, artwork, etc.

****主題內容；題材；內容****

Examples

1. The ****subject matter**** is quite technical.

這個****內容主題****相當技術性。

2. The film deals with difficult ****subject matter****.

這部電影處理很沉重的****題材****。

Key contrasts

29. subject vs topic

****subject****

= broad matter being discussed, studied, or written about

****主題；話題****

****topic****

= more specific point within a broader subject

****題目；議題****

Compare:

> Education is the general ****subject****.

> 教育是整體主題。

> Student motivation is today's ****topic****.

> 學生動機是今天的具體議題。

There is considerable overlap.

30. subject vs theme

****theme****

= underlying central idea or recurring message in a work

****主題；主旨****

****subject****

= what the work is about on the surface or generally

Compare:

> The ****subject**** of the novel is war.

> 這部小說的題材是戰爭。

> One major ****theme**** is the loss of innocence.

> 其中一個主要主題是純真的失落。

31. subject vs course

****subject****

= area of knowledge

****科目****

****course****

= organized programme of lessons in that subject

****課程****

Compare:

> Physics is the ****subject****.

> 物理是科目。

> This twelve-week physics programme is the ****course****.

> 這個十二週的物理班是課程。

32. subject vs lesson

****subject****

= what you study over a longer period

****科目****

****lesson****

= one teaching session within that subject

****一堂課****

Compare:

> Physics was my strongest **subject**.

> 物理是我最擅長的科目。

> Today's physics **lesson** was about light.

> 今天的物理課講的是光。

This contrast is directly relevant to the passage.

33. subject vs field

subject

= area studied or discussed

field

= broader area of professional, academic, or research activity

領域

Compare:

> Physics is a school **subject**.

> 物理是一門學校科目。

> Physics is also a scientific **field**.

> 物理也是一個科學領域。

34. subject vs participant

In research:

subject

= person being studied

受試者

participant

= person who takes part in research

參與者

Modern research writing often prefers **participant**, especially for human studies, because it emphasizes voluntary involvement.

35. subject vs object — grammar

****subject****

= who/what performs the action or is described

****object****

= who/what receives or is affected by the action

Example:

> ****The teacher**** explained ****the idea****.

* ****the teacher**** = subject

* ****the idea**** = object

Pronunciation note

36. subject has different stress as noun/adjective vs verb

Noun/adjective

****SUBject****

as in:

* school subject

* subject to change

Verb

subJECT

as in:

* subject someone to pressure

This stress shift is highly useful for learners.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****subject**** is:

****something or someone placed under consideration, study, discussion, or authority****

From this develop:

Education

school subject

→ ****科目****

Discussion

subject of conversation

→ ****話題****

Research

research subject

→ ****受試者****

Art

subject of a photograph

→ ****主體 / 題材****

Grammar

sentence subject

→ ****主語****

Political/historical

royal subject

→ ****臣民****

Verb

subject someone to pressure

→ ****使某人遭受****

Adjective phrase

subject to change

→ ****可能變更 / 受.....限制****

The passage uses the education branch:

****an area of knowledge studied at school****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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subject — school/academic	在學校、大學等正式學習或教授的一個知識領域；科目 / 學科
school subject	學校課程中正式教授的一門科目
subject — topic	人們正在談論、寫作、思考或研究的主題 / 話題
subject of a book/article	書籍、文章、演講等主要討論的內容 / 題材
subject — research participant	在實驗或研究中被觀察、測試或研究的人；受試者
subject — art/photo	照片、畫作等主要呈現或描繪的人 / 物；主體 / 題材
subject — monarch's citizen	受君主統治並效忠於其權威的人；臣民
subject — grammar	句子中通常表示動作者或被描述者的成分；主語 / 主詞
subject someone to something	使某人被迫經歷某事，尤其是不愉快的事
subject something to testing/analysis	使某物接受測試、分析、壓力等處理
subject to change	尚未完全固定，之後可能更改
subject to approval	必須先獲得批准才能生效
subject to something — vulnerable	容易遭受或受到某種情況影響
subject to law/rules	受某項法律、制度或規則約束
change the subject	停止原本話題並開始談另一件事
on the subject of...	說到 / 關於某一話題
subject matter	某作品、課程或討論所處理的主要內容 / 題材
subjective	受個人感受、觀點或判斷影響的；主觀的
subjectivity	個人觀點與感受對判斷所造成的主觀性

Passage recap

> “...because science had never been my strongest ****subject****.”

Here:

****subject**** = ****a particular area of knowledge studied at school****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****科目****

* **學科**

Natural contextual translation:

**因為理科從來都不是我最擅長的科目。 **

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

subject

= **an area of knowledge taught or studied in school, college, or university**

科目 ; 學科

The key contrast is:

> physics as a **subject**

> → 物理這門**科目**

versus:

> change the **subject**

> → **轉換話題**

and:

> a research **subject**

> → **研究對象 / 受試者**

Those are genuinely different meanings and should be kept separate in MCQs.